On 18 October 1962, President Kennedy meets the Soviet Foreign Minister, Andrei Gromyko (third left), accompanied by Soviet Ambassador, Anatoly Dobrynin (second left). The President learned of the missiles in Cuba two days earlier, but Gromyko continued to assert that no ‘offensive’ weapons were being sent. ‘[I] was told more barefaced lies than I have ever heard in so short a time,’ Kennedy said afterward. *(Public Domain: Robert L. Knusden)*



R-12 (NATO designation SS-4 Sandal) Medium Range Ballistic Missile. Thirty-six nuclear-capable R-12s reached Cuba. Another 24 R-14 Intermediate Range Ballistic Missiles were turned around and headed home when the blockade was announced. *(CC. Suvorow)*